

PREMIUM RESOURCE · AI & FINANCE AUTOMATION

Advanced AI Prompt Library

Finance Edition

150 tested, finance-specific AI prompts across 12 use cases — variance analysis, forecasting, audit prep, board reporting, and more.

150 Prompts

12 Use Case Categories

R.C.T.F. Framework

Premium · €45

150

prompts

12

categories

R.C.T.F.

framework

3

before/after pairs

HOW TO USE THIS LIBRARY

Every prompt in this library is written using the R.C.T.F. framework explained in Section 1 — a role, the relevant context, a specific task, and a defined output format, woven into one ready-to-use instruction. Copy a prompt, replace the bracketed [paste data] placeholder with your own figures, and adjust the specifics to your organisation. These are starting points to adapt, not scripts to use unchanged.

SECTION 1

The R.C.T.F. Framework

Role, Context, Task, Format — the four elements that separate a prompt that works reliably from one that produces something different every time you run it.

The Four Elements

1

Role

Who should the AI act as? A defined role shapes vocabulary, level of detail, and what's assumed to already be understood — “senior FP&A analyst” produces different output than “explain this to a new graduate.”

2

Context

What background does the AI need that it can't otherwise know? The specific data, the situation, and any constraints that shape a correct answer.

3

Task

What, specifically, should the AI do? Not “help with this” — a precise instruction naming exactly what output is needed.

4 Format

How should the output be structured? Length, structure, tone, and audience — left undefined, the model will guess, and guess differently each time.

A Worked Example

ROLE	You are a senior FP&A analyst with five years of experience presenting to non-finance executives.
CONTEXT	You've been given this month's departmental spend report showing actuals versus budget across six departments, with a 12% overall unfavourable variance concentrated in Marketing and IT.
TASK	Identify the two largest variance drivers, explain each in plain language suitable for a COO with no finance background, and note whether either looks like a timing difference that will reverse next month.
FORMAT	A maximum 120-word summary in plain paragraphs, no finance jargon without a one-clause explanation, ending with a single recommended follow-up question for the department heads.

Combine the four elements into one instruction: In practice, a well-written prompt weaves Role, Context, Task, and Format into flowing instruction text — you don't need to literally label each part every time, once you've internalised the pattern. Every prompt in Section 4 is written this way.

SECTION 2

Before / After Examples

Three real transformations showing what the R.C.T.F. framework actually changes about a prompt's output.

Variance Commentary

BEFORE

"Explain this month's variance."

AFTER (R.C.T.F. APPLIED)

"You are a controller drafting variance commentary for the monthly board pack. Using the attached departmental P&L variance data, explain the overall EBITDA variance versus budget in a maximum 150-word narrative written for a non-finance board audience. Avoid unexplained jargon, and flag explicitly if any driver looks like a timing difference rather than a genuine trend."

Why it works better: The "before" version gives the model no role, no data context, no length constraint, and no audience — it will guess at all four, and guess differently every time you run it.

Cash Flow Forecast Narrative

BEFORE

"Write a cash flow summary."

AFTER (R.C.T.F. APPLIED)

"You are a treasury analyst preparing a weekly cash update for the CFO. Using this 13-week rolling cash flow model, summarise whether the company stays above its \$500K minimum cash threshold for the full period, name the single week with the tightest position, and flag any assumption in the model that looks unusually optimistic. Limit your answer to 100 words in plain prose, no bullet points."

Why it works better: Naming the specific threshold, the specific audience, and an explicit instruction to flag optimistic assumptions turns a generic summary request into something that produces a genuinely useful, decision-ready answer.

Audit Sample Documentation

BEFORE

"Help me document this test."

AFTER (R.C.T.F. APPLIED)

"You are preparing SOX control-testing workpapers for an external auditor's review. For the attached sample of 25 invoice approvals, draft a testing summary stating the sample size, the testing method used, the number of exceptions found, and a one-sentence conclusion on whether the control operated effectively. Use the exact heading structure: Objective, Sample, Method, Results, Conclusion."

Why it works better: Auditors expect a specific documentation structure — naming it explicitly, rather than leaving format to the model's judgment, avoids a rewrite cycle later.

SECTION 3

Prompt Optimisation Guide

How to refine a prompt that isn't quite working, rather than abandoning it and starting over.

- 1 Change one element at a time**
If a prompt's output isn't right, adjust Role, Context, Task, or Format individually and re-run — changing all four at once makes it impossible to tell what actually fixed it.
- 2 Add a negative constraint if the output keeps making the same mistake**
If a model keeps including something you don't want — jargon, speculation, a specific structure — state explicitly what to avoid, not just what to include.
- 3 Narrow the Task before you give up on a prompt**
A prompt that produces vague, generic output usually has too broad a Task — narrowing scope almost always helps more than adding more Context.
- 4 Ask the model to show its reasoning for a judgment call**
For any prompt involving interpretation — which variance is most concerning, which risk is highest — ask it to briefly state why, so you can spot-check the reasoning, not just accept the conclusion.
- 5 Test a prompt on a case you already know the right answer to**
Before relying on a new prompt for real work, run it against data where you already know what a good answer looks like, and check the output specifically against that known answer.

Common pitfall: Rewriting a prompt from scratch every time it doesn't work perfectly. Small, targeted adjustments to Context or Format usually solve the problem faster than a full rewrite, and preserve whatever was already working.

SECTION 4

The 150-Prompt Library

Organised into 12 use case categories — copy any prompt, replace the bracketed placeholder with your own data, and adjust the specifics to your organisation.

Variance Analysis & Commentary

13 prompts

001. You are a senior FP&A analyst reviewing this month's departmental spend data [paste data]. Identify the three largest variances versus budget, explain the likely driver for each based on the line-item detail provided, and flag any variance that looks like a possible coding error rather than a genuine business change. Present the answer as a table with columns for Department, Variance (\$ and %), Likely Driver, and Confidence (High/Medium/Low).

002. You are a controller drafting variance commentary for the monthly management pack. Using the attached P&L variance data [paste data], write a maximum 150-word narrative explaining the overall EBITDA variance versus budget for a non-finance executive audience, avoiding jargon like "accrual" or "true-up" without a one-clause explanation.

003. You are an FP&A analyst. Given this list of GL account variances [paste data], group them into three categories — timing differences that will reverse next period, genuine business drivers, and potential errors requiring investigation. Return three separate bulleted lists, one per category.

004. You are a regional finance manager preparing for a variance review call. Using this quarter's revenue variance by product line [paste data], draft five specific questions to ask the sales team that would help confirm or rule out each of the two largest unexplained variances.

005. You are an FP&A analyst summarising headcount cost variance. Using this month's actual versus budgeted headcount cost by department [paste data], identify whether the variance is driven primarily by open-role vacancy savings, unplanned overtime, or a rate change, and state your reasoning in under 100 words.

006. You are a cost centre owner reviewing your own budget performance. Using this month's line-item actuals versus budget for your cost centre [paste data], draft a two-sentence explanation for the single largest unfavourable line, suitable to paste directly into a management commentary template.

007. You are an FP&A analyst comparing this quarter's gross margin to the same quarter last year [paste data]. Decompose the year-over-year change into price, volume, and mix effects as clearly as the data allows, and state explicitly if the data isn't granular enough to separate all three cleanly.

008. You are a finance business partner supporting a sales team. Using this month's commission expense actual versus budget [paste data], check whether the variance is proportional to the revenue variance for the same period, and flag if commission expense moved out of proportion to revenue.

009. You are an FP&A analyst preparing a flux analysis for balance sheet accounts. Using this month-end versus prior-month balance sheet extract [paste data], identify any account that moved by more than 15% and requires a flux explanation, listed by account name and dollar movement.

010. You are a controller reviewing capital expenditure variance. Using this quarter's capex actual versus approved budget by project [paste data], identify any project running more than 10% over its approved amount and draft a one-line status note for each, suitable for a capex tracking report.

011. You are an FP&A analyst summarising variance trends over time. Using the last four months of the same variance line item [paste data], state whether the variance is a one-time event, an improving trend, or a worsening trend, and support your answer with the specific monthly figures.

012. You are a finance manager preparing a variance escalation. Using this cost centre's three-month variance history [paste data], draft a two-sentence escalation note to the department head explaining why this specific line item needs a corrective action plan, not just an explanation.

013. You are an FP&A analyst reconciling two conflicting variance explanations. Given this department head's stated reason for a variance [paste explanation] and the actual transaction-level detail [paste data], state plainly whether the transaction detail supports the stated explanation, and if not, what it actually shows.

Financial Forecasting & Scenario Planning

13 prompts

014. You are a treasury analyst maintaining a 13-week rolling cash flow forecast. Using this week's actual cash position and the existing forecast assumptions [paste data], update the forecast for any week where actuals differed from the prior forecast by more than 10%, and flag which weeks are now closest to breaching the minimum cash threshold.

015. You are an FP&A analyst building a revenue forecast. Using the last 12 months of actual revenue by product line [paste data], draft three growth-rate assumptions — conservative, base case, and optimistic — for next quarter, and state the specific historical pattern each assumption is based on.

016. You are a finance manager stress-testing a forecast. Using this quarter's forecast model assumptions [paste data], identify the single assumption the forecast result is most sensitive to, and describe in plain language what would happen to the bottom-line forecast if that assumption were 20% worse than assumed.

017. You are an FP&A analyst preparing a scenario model for leadership. Using this year's actual cost structure [paste data], build a best-case, base-case, and worst-case operating expense scenario for next year, each with one clearly stated driving assumption, presented as a simple three-column table.

018. You are a demand planner supporting the finance team. Using the last two years of monthly sales data [paste data], identify whether there's a clear seasonal pattern, and if so, state which months are typically strongest and weakest as a percentage of annual total.

019. You are an FP&A analyst validating a forecast against reality. Using this month's actual results and what was forecast for this same month three months ago [paste data], calculate the forecast accuracy as a percentage and identify the single line item with the largest forecast miss.

020. You are a finance business partner building a headcount forecast. Using the current approved headcount plan and this quarter's actual hiring pace [paste data], project whether the team will be over or under its approved headcount by year-end, and by roughly how many roles.

021. You are an FP&A analyst preparing a working capital forecast. Using the last six months of receivables and payables data [paste data], project the expected cash conversion cycle for next quarter, and flag if it's trending in an unfavourable direction.

022. You are a finance manager building a hiring-cost scenario. Using the fully loaded cost per role by department [paste data], calculate the incremental annual cost of the ten open positions currently in the hiring pipeline, broken out by department.

023. You are an FP&A analyst assessing forecast risk from a single large customer. Using this customer's historical order pattern and the current forecast assumption for their next order [paste data], state whether the forecast assumption is consistent with their actual historical ordering behaviour.

024. You are a treasury analyst modelling a foreign exchange scenario. Using this quarter's foreign-currency-denominated revenue and a set of three exchange rate scenarios [paste data], calculate the resulting revenue range in reporting currency for each scenario.

025. You are an FP&A analyst building a break-even analysis. Using this product line's current fixed costs, variable cost per unit, and price per unit [paste data], calculate the break-even unit volume and state how far current actual volume is above or below that threshold.

026. You are a finance manager preparing a hiring-freeze scenario for leadership. Using the current approved budget and headcount plan [paste data], calculate the projected annual savings if all currently open, unfilled roles remain unfilled through year-end.

Board & Executive Reporting

13 prompts

027. You are a CFO's chief of staff preparing the board deck. Using this quarter's key financial metrics [paste data], draft a one-slide executive summary with no more than five bullet points, each stating a metric, its value, and a one-clause comparison to plan or prior year.

028. You are a finance director preparing board materials. Using this quarter's actual results versus the annual plan [paste data], draft three specific discussion questions a board member might reasonably ask, along with a one-sentence suggested response to each.

029. You are a CFO preparing an investor update. Using this quarter's revenue and margin trend over the last four quarters [paste data], draft a two-sentence narrative describing the trend in plain, non-promotional language suitable for a factual investor update.

030. You are a finance director drafting board pack risk commentary. Using this quarter's top three identified financial risks and their current mitigation status [paste data], draft a concise risk summary table with columns for Risk, Likelihood, Impact, and Current Mitigation.

031. You are a CFO's team member preparing a board KPI dashboard. Using this quarter's actual values for the company's five key financial KPIs [paste data], flag which KPIs are outside their normal historical range and by how much.

032. You are a finance director summarising a capital allocation decision for the board. Using the business case data for a proposed capital investment [paste data], draft a three-sentence summary covering the ask, the expected return, and the single biggest risk to that return.

033. You are a CFO preparing year-end guidance commentary. Using this year's actual results through the most recent month and the original annual guidance [paste data], state plainly whether the company is tracking to, above, or below its original guidance, and by roughly how much.

034. You are a finance director preparing a board update on a cost reduction initiative. Using the initiative's target savings and actual savings achieved to date [paste data], draft a status update stating percentage of target achieved and the primary reason for any shortfall.

035. You are a CFO preparing a board-level liquidity update. Using the current cash position, available credit facility headroom, and near-term cash obligations [paste data], draft a two-sentence liquidity summary stating the total available liquidity and the next material cash outflow.

036. You are a finance director preparing an M&A integration update for the board. Using the actual versus planned synergy realisation to date [paste data], draft a status summary stating percentage of planned synergies realised and the timeline to full realisation.

037. You are a CFO drafting board commentary on margin trends. Using gross margin by product line over the last four quarters [paste data], identify which product line has the most concerning margin trend and state the specific quarters that show the deterioration.

038. You are a finance director preparing an audit committee update. Using this quarter's internal control testing results [paste data], draft a summary stating the number of controls tested, the number of exceptions found, and whether any exception is significant enough to warrant audit committee attention.

039. You are a CFO preparing a board update on debt covenant compliance. Using the current financial covenant calculations against their required thresholds [paste data], state plainly whether the company is in compliance with each covenant and how much headroom exists on the tightest one.

Audit Preparation & Support

12 prompts

040. You are preparing SOX control-testing workpapers for an external auditor's review. For this sample of invoice approvals [paste data], draft a testing summary stating the sample size, the testing method used, the number of exceptions found, and a one-sentence conclusion on whether the control operated effectively.

041. You are a controller preparing a PBC (prepared-by-client) list response. Using this auditor request for supporting documentation [paste request] and the available source records [paste data], draft a response stating what's being provided, what's not available, and why.

042. You are a finance manager preparing for an audit walkthrough. Using this process narrative for the procure-to-pay cycle [paste narrative], identify any step described vaguely enough that an auditor might ask a follow-up question, and suggest a more specific rewording.

043. You are preparing account reconciliation documentation for audit review. Using this month's bank reconciliation with two outstanding reconciling items [paste data], draft a one-sentence explanation for each reconciling item suitable for an auditor's workpaper.

044. You are a controller responding to an audit exception. Using the auditor's stated exception [paste exception] and the actual transaction detail related to it [paste data], draft a management response explaining the root cause and the corrective action being taken.

045. You are preparing a sample selection for control testing. Using this population of 500 transactions [paste data description], describe an appropriate sampling approach to select 25 transactions for testing, and state the rationale for the sample size chosen.

046. You are a finance manager documenting an internal control for the first time. Using this description of how expense reports are currently approved [paste description], draft a formal control narrative including control objective, control activity, frequency, and control owner.

047. You are preparing supporting documentation for a significant unusual transaction. Using the transaction details and business rationale [paste data], draft a memo explaining the transaction's nature, its accounting treatment, and why that treatment is appropriate.

048. You are a controller preparing a management representation letter input. Using this quarter's known contingencies and subsequent events [paste data], draft a summary of items that should be considered for inclusion in the representation letter.

049. You are preparing documentation for a related-party transaction disclosure. Using the transaction details [paste data], draft a summary stating the nature of the relationship, the transaction terms, and confirmation of whether terms were consistent with arm's-length pricing.

050. You are a finance manager preparing an audit trail explanation for an unusual journal entry. Using the journal entry detail and its business justification [paste data], draft a one-paragraph explanation suitable to attach as supporting documentation.

051. You are preparing a fraud risk assessment input for the audit team. Using this process's current control environment description [paste description], identify the two points in the process most vulnerable to override or manipulation, and state why.

Month-End Close & Reconciliation

12 prompts

052. You are a staff accountant preparing a bank reconciliation. Using this month's bank statement and the general ledger cash account [paste data], identify all reconciling items, categorise each as timing or error, and state the adjusted book balance.

053. You are a controller reviewing the close checklist status. Using this month's close task list with completion status [paste data], identify which tasks are behind schedule relative to the close calendar, and draft a one-line escalation note for each.

054. You are an accountant preparing an accrual entry. Using this vendor's historical monthly spend pattern and the invoice not yet received [paste data], estimate an appropriate accrual amount and state the basis for the estimate.

055. You are a staff accountant reviewing intercompany balances. Using this month's intercompany receivable and payable balances between two entities [paste data], identify whether they net to zero as expected, and if not, state the size of the discrepancy.

056. You are a controller reviewing the trial balance for close. Using this month's trial balance extract [paste data], flag any account balance that looks unusual relative to its typical range over the last six months.

057. You are an accountant preparing a prepaid expense schedule. Using the original prepaid amount, the amortisation period, and months elapsed [paste data], calculate the correct remaining prepaid balance and the amount to expense this period.

058. You are a staff accountant reviewing fixed asset additions for the month. Using this month's capital asset additions listing [paste data], confirm each addition has the required supporting documentation noted, and flag any missing an asset classification.

059. You are a controller reviewing manual journal entries before close. Using this list of manual journal entries posted this period [paste data], flag any entry lacking a clear description or supporting reference, since these are the entries most likely to draw audit questions.

060. You are an accountant reconciling a subledger to the general ledger. Using the accounts receivable subledger total and the GL control account balance [paste data], state the size of any discrepancy and suggest the most likely cause based on common reconciliation issues.

061. You are a controller preparing close-cycle time analysis. Using the last four months of close calendar actual completion dates [paste data], identify which specific close task consistently takes longest relative to its scheduled time.

062. You are a staff accountant preparing a revenue recognition check. Using this list of contracts with their recognition method and amounts recognised this period [paste data], confirm the recognised amount is consistent with the stated method for each contract.

063. You are a controller documenting a late close adjustment. Using the adjustment amount, the account affected, and the reason it was identified after the initial close [paste data], draft a brief memo documenting why the adjustment was needed and its impact.

Budget Planning & Analysis

12 prompts

064. You are an FP&A analyst supporting the annual budget process. Using this department's current-year actual spend by category [paste data], draft three specific questions to ask the department head that would help validate their proposed next-year budget increase.

065. You are a finance business partner reviewing a submitted budget. Using this department's proposed budget versus their current-year run-rate [paste data], identify any line item where the proposed budget seems inconsistent with recent actual spending trends.

066. You are an FP&A analyst consolidating departmental budget submissions. Using budget submissions from five departments [paste data], identify the two departments requesting the largest percentage increases and state the stated justification for each.

067. You are a finance manager preparing a zero-based budgeting exercise. Using this cost centre's current spend by line item [paste data], draft one clarifying question per line item that would need to be answered to justify that spend from a zero base.

068. You are an FP&A analyst comparing budget to a rolling forecast. Using the original annual budget and the latest quarterly forecast update [paste data], identify which line items have moved most significantly from the original budget assumption.

069. You are a finance business partner reviewing a marketing budget request. Using historical marketing spend and its associated revenue impact where available [paste data], draft two questions that would help assess whether the proposed increase is likely to be justified by return.

070. You are an FP&A analyst preparing a budget variance threshold policy. Using this list of typical monthly variance sizes by department over the last year [paste data], suggest a reasonable variance threshold percentage that would flag genuinely unusual months without flagging routine noise.

071. You are a finance manager reviewing a capital budget request. Using the proposed project's cost, expected payback period, and strategic rationale [paste data], draft a two-sentence summary suitable for a capital approval committee.

072. You are an FP&A analyst building a budget-to-actual dashboard specification. Using the finance team's stated reporting needs [paste description], draft a list of the specific metrics and comparison periods the dashboard should include.

073. You are a finance business partner supporting a department head through budget cuts. Using the department's current budget and a required 10% reduction target [paste data], suggest three specific line items to review first based on which appear most discretionary.

074. You are an FP&A analyst analysing budget accuracy by department. Using the last four quarters of budget versus actual by department [paste data], identify which department has the most consistently accurate budgeting and which has the largest recurring misses.

075. You are a finance manager preparing a budget assumptions document. Using this year's key planning assumptions — headcount growth, inflation rate, and revenue growth target [paste data], draft a one-page summary suitable to circulate to department heads before they build their budgets.

Cash Flow & Treasury

12 prompts

076. You are a treasury analyst reviewing daily cash positions. Using this week's daily cash balance and known upcoming payments [paste data], identify the specific day the cash position is tightest and state the projected balance on that day.

077. You are a finance manager analysing days sales outstanding. Using this quarter's accounts receivable aging by customer [paste data], identify the three customers contributing most to the overall DSO increase.

078. You are a treasury analyst preparing a covenant compliance check. Using the current quarter's financial figures and the covenant calculation formula [paste data], calculate the covenant ratio and state the current headroom versus the required threshold.

079. You are a finance manager reviewing accounts payable timing. Using this month's payables aging and available early-payment discount terms [paste data], identify which payments would benefit most from early payment given the discount offered.

080. You are a treasury analyst assessing foreign currency exposure. Using this quarter's revenue and costs by currency [paste data], state the company's net exposure by currency and which single currency represents the largest unhedged risk.

081. You are a finance manager preparing a working capital improvement plan. Using the current cash conversion cycle components — DSO, DPO, and DIO [paste data], identify which single lever offers the largest potential improvement and why.

082. You are a treasury analyst reviewing bank fee statements. Using this month's bank fee detail across all accounts [paste data], identify any fee category that increased significantly versus the prior month and flag it for review.

083. You are a finance manager assessing customer credit risk. Using this customer's payment history over the last six invoices [paste data], state whether their payment pattern is deteriorating and suggest whether a credit limit review is warranted.

084. You are a treasury analyst preparing an investment sweep recommendation. Using the current excess cash balance and available short-term investment options [paste data], suggest an allocation and state the reasoning behind it.

085. You are a finance manager reviewing debt maturity schedule. Using the company's current debt instruments and their maturity dates [paste data], identify which maturity is coming due soonest and whether a refinancing conversation should start now.

086. You are a treasury analyst preparing a cash pooling analysis. Using cash balances across multiple entity bank accounts [paste data], identify which entities are cash-rich and which are cash-short, to support an intercompany funding decision.

087. You are a finance manager assessing letter of credit utilisation. Using the current letter of credit facility, its utilisation, and expiring facilities [paste data], flag any facility expiring within 60 days that will need renewal.

Vendor & Expense Management

12 prompts

088. You are an AP analyst reviewing vendor spend concentration. Using this year's spend by vendor [paste data], identify the top five vendors by total spend and state what percentage of total AP spend they represent combined.

089. You are a finance manager reviewing expense policy compliance. Using this batch of expense report line items [paste data], flag any expense that appears to exceed the stated policy limit for its category.

090. You are an AP analyst investigating duplicate payment risk. Using this list of invoices from the last quarter [paste data], flag any pair of invoices with the same vendor, amount, and a date within five days of each other as a possible duplicate.

091. You are a finance manager preparing a vendor consolidation analysis. Using spend by vendor within a single category, such as office supplies [paste data], identify whether spend is fragmented across many vendors in a way that suggests a consolidation opportunity.

092. You are an AP analyst reviewing payment terms compliance. Using this sample of vendor invoices and their stated payment terms versus actual payment date [paste data], flag any vendor consistently paid later than their stated terms.

093. You are a finance manager assessing travel expense trends. Using the last four quarters of travel expense by department [paste data], identify which department's travel spend has grown fastest and by what percentage.

094. You are an AP analyst reviewing new vendor onboarding. Using this new vendor's submitted documentation [paste description of what was submitted], identify any standard onboarding requirement that appears to be missing.

095. You are a finance manager reviewing procurement card spend. Using this month's card transactions by cardholder [paste data], flag any transaction that falls into a category typically requiring pre-approval, such as software subscriptions.

096. You are an AP analyst preparing a vendor risk review. Using this vendor's payment history, contract value, and how critical they are to operations [paste description], draft a one-paragraph risk summary for the vendor management file.

097. You are a finance manager analysing expense report processing time. Using the submission date and approval date for this batch of expense reports [paste data], calculate the average processing time and flag any report that took notably longer than average.

098. You are an AP analyst reviewing contract renewal timing. Using this list of vendor contracts and their renewal dates [paste data], flag any contract renewing within 90 days that should be reviewed before automatic renewal.

099. You are a finance manager assessing software subscription spend. Using this list of active software subscriptions and their last-known usage data [paste data], flag any subscription that appears to be significantly underused relative to its cost.

Financial Modelling & Analysis

13 prompts

100. You are a financial analyst building a unit economics model. Using the revenue and direct cost per unit for this product line [paste data], calculate the contribution margin per unit and state how many units are needed to cover a given fixed cost base.

101. You are an FP&A analyst reviewing a discounted cash flow model's assumptions. Using the model's stated growth rate, discount rate, and terminal value assumption [paste data], identify which single assumption the valuation is most sensitive to.

102. You are a financial analyst preparing a customer lifetime value estimate. Using average customer revenue, gross margin, and average customer retention period [paste data], calculate an estimated customer lifetime value and state the key assumption driving it.

103. You are an FP&A analyst building a make-versus-buy comparison. Using the cost of building a capability in-house versus an outsourcing quote [paste data], calculate the breakeven point in years and state which option is cheaper before and after that point.

104. You are a financial analyst reviewing a pricing scenario. Using current price, volume, and a proposed price change with an estimated volume impact [paste data], calculate the net revenue impact of the proposed price change.

105. You are an FP&A analyst building a payback period calculation. Using an investment's upfront cost and expected annual net cash inflow [paste data], calculate the simple payback period in months.

106. You are a financial analyst comparing two financing options. Using the terms of a loan versus a lease for the same asset [paste data], calculate the total cost of each option over the asset's useful life and state which is cheaper.

107. You are an FP&A analyst preparing a headcount productivity metric. Using revenue and total headcount over the last four quarters [paste data], calculate revenue per employee for each quarter and state the trend direction.

108. You are a financial analyst building a churn-adjusted revenue model. Using starting monthly recurring revenue, new revenue added, and revenue lost to churn [paste data], calculate the net revenue retention rate for the period.

109. You are an FP&A analyst reviewing a cost allocation methodology. Using shared overhead costs and the allocation basis currently used, such as headcount or revenue [paste data], recalculate the allocation and flag if any department's allocated share seems disproportionate to its actual usage.

110. You are a financial analyst preparing a working capital requirement estimate. Using projected revenue growth and the current working-capital-to-revenue ratio [paste data], estimate the incremental working capital needed to support the growth.

111. You are an FP&A analyst building a margin bridge. Using this year's and last year's revenue, cost of goods sold, and operating expenses [paste data], decompose the year-over-year change in operating margin into its component drivers.

112. You are a financial analyst assessing a discount's true cost. Using a proposed early-payment discount percentage and the number of days it accelerates payment [paste data], calculate the annualised cost of offering that discount and compare it to the company's cost of capital.

Compliance & Risk Documentation

12 prompts

113. You are a finance manager preparing a risk register entry. Using a newly identified financial process risk and its potential impact [paste description], draft a formal risk register entry including risk description, likelihood, impact, and proposed mitigation.

114. You are a controller documenting a new internal control. Using a description of a process change intended to close a control gap [paste description], draft a control narrative stating the control objective, the specific activity, and how its operation will be evidenced.

115. You are a finance manager preparing a segregation-of-duties review. Using a list of who currently has access to initiate, approve, and post transactions in a given process [paste data], flag any individual with access to more than one of these three functions.

116. You are a controller preparing a data privacy impact summary for a new finance tool. Using a description of what personal or financial data the tool will access [paste description], draft a summary of the data types involved and who within the organisation will have access.

117. You are a finance manager reviewing regulatory change impact. Using a summary of an upcoming accounting standard change and the company's current relevant policy [paste description], draft a list of the specific areas of current policy that will need updating.

118. You are a controller preparing a whistleblower hotline report summary. Using this quarter's hotline reports relevant to finance [paste description], draft a summary categorising each by type and current investigation status, without including any personally identifying detail.

119. You are a finance manager documenting a business continuity plan for the close process. Using a description of the current close process and its key dependencies [paste description], draft a list of the specific failure points that would most disrupt the ability to close the books on time.

120. You are a controller preparing a conflict-of-interest disclosure summary. Using submitted disclosure forms from finance team members [paste description], draft a summary flagging any disclosure that would warrant a follow-up conversation.

121. You are a finance manager reviewing third-party risk for a new vendor with system access. Using a description of the access the vendor will require [paste description], draft a list of specific security and data questions that should be answered before granting that access.

122. You are a controller preparing a policy exception log entry. Using details of an approved exception to standard financial policy [paste description], draft a log entry stating what the exception was, who approved it, and the business justification.

123. You are a finance manager preparing a records retention compliance check. Using the company's stated retention policy and a sample of document ages currently on file [paste description], flag any document category that appears to be retained longer than policy requires.

124. You are a controller drafting a compliance training gap analysis. Using a list of required compliance training topics and current team completion status [paste data], identify which team members have outstanding required training and how overdue each is.

Investor & Stakeholder Communication

13 prompts

125. You are an investor relations analyst preparing earnings call talking points. Using this quarter's key financial results versus analyst expectations [paste data], draft three likely analyst questions and a one-sentence factual response to each.

126. You are a finance director preparing a lender update. Using the current quarter's financial covenant calculations [paste data], draft a factual summary letter stating compliance status for each covenant and current headroom.

127. You are an investor relations analyst drafting an earnings press release financial summary. Using this quarter's headline financial results [paste data], draft the standard financial highlights paragraph in the plain, factual style typical of a results announcement.

128. You are a finance director preparing a shareholder letter section on financial performance. Using this year's key results versus the prior year [paste data], draft a factual, non-promotional paragraph summarising the year's financial performance.

129. You are an investor relations analyst preparing a peer benchmarking summary. Using the company's key financial metrics alongside two named competitors' publicly reported figures [paste data], draft a factual comparison table.

130. You are a finance director responding to a specific investor question received in writing. Using the investor's question [paste question] and the relevant internal financial data [paste data], draft a factual, precise response avoiding any forward-looking commitment beyond what's already been publicly guided.

131. You are an investor relations analyst preparing a non-GAAP reconciliation summary. Using the GAAP result and each non-GAAP adjustment applied [paste data], draft a table reconciling from GAAP to the non-GAAP figure with a one-line description of each adjustment.

132. You are a finance director preparing materials for a credit rating agency review. Using the company's current leverage ratios and recent trend [paste data], draft a factual summary of the current position and the trend direction over the last four quarters.

133. You are an investor relations analyst preparing a dividend announcement financial rationale. Using the company's current cash position, payout ratio, and free cash flow [paste data], draft a factual paragraph explaining the financial basis for the proposed dividend level.

134. You are a finance director preparing a response to a proxy advisory firm's question on capital allocation. Using the company's capital allocation framework and recent capital deployment data [paste data], draft a factual response describing how capital was actually allocated versus the stated framework.

135. You are an investor relations analyst preparing guidance reaffirmation language. Using year-to-date actual results against full-year guidance [paste data], draft a factual statement on whether guidance is being reaffirmed, raised, or lowered, and the specific data supporting that call.

136. You are a finance director preparing a private equity investor update. Using this quarter's key operating and financial metrics against the investment thesis milestones [paste data], draft a factual status update against each milestone.

137. You are an investor relations analyst preparing a segment reporting summary. Using revenue and margin by business segment for the current and prior period [paste data], draft a factual paragraph describing the relative performance of each segment.

Process Documentation & Training

13 prompts

138. You are a finance manager documenting the month-end close process for a new team member. Using a description of the current close steps in the order they happen [paste description], draft a numbered step-by-step process document with an owner and estimated duration for each step.

139. You are a controller creating a training guide for a new AI tool being introduced to the team. Using a description of what the tool does and its intended use case [paste description], draft a simple one-page quick-start guide covering what it's for, how to use it, and when to escalate to a human review.

140. You are a finance manager documenting an approval workflow. Using a description of the current invoice approval process, including thresholds and approvers [paste description], draft a clear process document stating exactly which approval level applies at which dollar threshold.

141. You are a controller preparing a desk procedure document for a role that's about to change hands. Using a description of everything the current role holder does in a typical month [paste description], draft a structured desk procedure organised by weekly, monthly, and quarterly tasks.

142. You are a finance manager documenting a data reconciliation procedure. Using a description of how two systems are currently manually reconciled each month [paste description], draft a step-by-step reconciliation procedure that a new team member could follow without additional guidance.

143. You are a controller preparing an escalation procedure document. Using a description of the types of issues that currently get escalated and to whom [paste description], draft a simple escalation matrix stating issue type, first point of contact, and when to escalate further.

144. You are a finance manager creating a new-hire onboarding checklist for the finance team. Using a description of the systems, access, and initial training a new finance hire typically needs [paste description], draft a first-30-days onboarding checklist.

145. You are a controller documenting a control procedure for a newly automated process. Using a description of what changed when the process was automated [paste description], draft an updated control narrative reflecting the new automated steps and where human review still occurs.

146. You are a finance manager preparing a process improvement proposal document. Using a description of a current manual process and a proposed automated alternative [paste description], draft a one-page proposal stating the current state, proposed state, and expected time savings.

147. You are a controller creating a reference guide for common journal entry types. Using a list of the most frequently posted manual journal entry types and their typical debit/credit treatment [paste description], draft a quick-reference guide organised by entry type.

148. You are a finance manager documenting a vendor setup procedure. Using a description of the current steps to onboard a new vendor into the system [paste description], draft a step-by-step procedure stating required documentation and approval steps at each stage.

149. You are a controller preparing a year-end close calendar. Using a description of the specific additional tasks required at year-end beyond a normal month-end close [paste description], draft a year-end close calendar listing each additional task and its target completion date relative to year-end.

150. You are a finance manager creating a troubleshooting guide for a common recurring issue. Using a description of a problem that comes up repeatedly, such as a recurring reconciliation break [paste description], draft a troubleshooting guide listing the most likely causes in order of likelihood and how to check each one.

A CLOSING NOTE

No prompt library replaces professional judgment — every output here still needs the same review discipline covered in this category's AI Hallucination Risk Guide. Treat these 150 prompts as a genuinely useful starting point for consistent, well-structured requests, not a substitute for checking what comes back.

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CUSTOM PROMPT DEVELOPMENT

For a bespoke prompt library built around your team's specific systems, terminology, and recurring tasks — a tailored engagement is available on request.

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